WHO SAID WHAT ON FREEBIES

NARENDRA MODI, *Prime Minister of India*



"If there is selfishness in politics, then anyone can come and announce to give free petrol and diesel. Such steps will take away the rights of our children, and prevent the country from becoming self-reliant. Due to such selfish policies, the burden on honest taxpayers of the country will also increase"

SUPREME COURT OF INDIA



"We cannot prevent political parties from making promises. The question is what constitutes right promises? Can we describe promise of free education as a freebie? Can drinking water, minimum essential units of powers etc. be described as freebies? Can consumer products and free electronics be described as welfare? The concern right now is what is the right way of spending public money"

NIRMALA SITHARAMAN, *Finance Minister*



"You may promise something... but make sure you understand the fiscal strength of your state and having promised it during the election, you won, you come back, ensure that you fulfil it because you have given a word and how, by making sure that your budget will have a provision for it"



BHAGWANT S. MANN
CM, Punjab
"I want to ask Pradhan Mantri *saab*: we are giving facilities out of the tax paid by people and you are calling them *revdis*? You are waiving Rs 10 lakh crore debt of your friends, what is that?"



NAVEEN PATNAIK
CM, Odisha
"Whether it's our Kalia Yojana, Mission Shakti or Biju Swasthya Kalyan Yojana or rice at Re 1 a kilo, all these programmes have empowered people"



MANOHAR LAL
CM, Haryana
"They are making people lazy by distributing freebies... This 'sit down policy' of the Opposition is a resisting force in PM Modi's dream of Aatmanirbhar India"



ASHOK GEHLOT
CM, Rajasthan
"It is a shame that PM calls social welfare measures *revdis*. I am proud that we are giving pensions to one crore people, have free OPD and medicines and tests in government hospitals, and free IPD up to Rs 10 lakh... Along with some relief in electricity bills, these measures are to empower people"



SHIVRAJ SINGH CHOUHAN
CM, Madhya Pradesh
"*Revdi* culture means that just to get votes, a competition begins wherein one party says, 'I will give a fridge,' the other says, 'I will give a TV'... this is not right"



Y.S. JAGAN MOHAN REDDY,
CM, Andhra Pradesh
"Programmes implemented only to lure voters can be termed freebies, but painting schemes of vast socio-economic importance implemented to alleviate distress with the same brush is an insult to the constitutional mandate"



BHUPESH BAGHEL
CM, Chhattisgarh
"What is seen as a freebie for one set of people may be a necessary social support system for another group. The definition of freebie can't come out of sheer